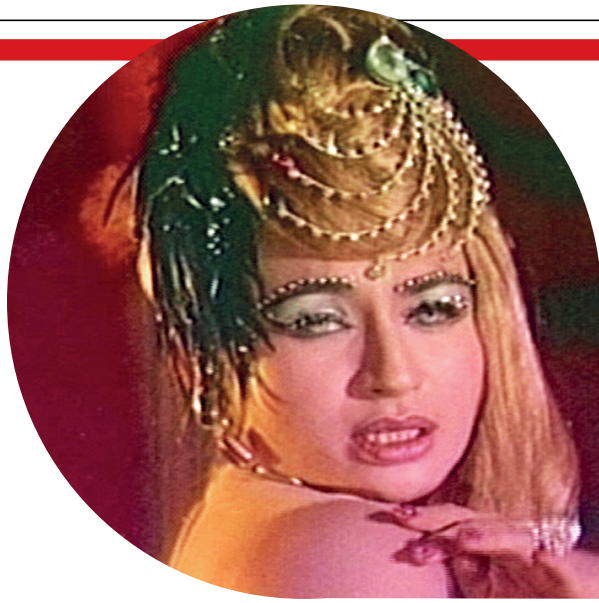


Aa Jane Jaa / O Haseena Zulfonwali

***Intaqam* (1969) / *Teesri Manzil* (1966)**

It's criminal to do a list and not have dances by the luminous Helen, who delighted audiences for decades with her terpsichorean talent. Whether *lavani* ('*O Mungda*', *Inkaar*) or cabaret, she aced it all. She and choreographer P.L. Raj were a winning combination, giving us some magical memories. *Aa Jaane Jaa* is a soft Lata number where Helen seduces without ever seeming vulgar. And *O Haseena* is right out of the vibrant club scene of the 1960s, with Shammi Kapoor complementing Helen, one of those joyous instances when the hero is equally eager to show off his moves.



Chadh Gayo Papi Bichua

***Madhumati* (1958)**

Sachin Shankar, a student and cousin of the legendary Uday Shankar, delivers this folksy routine with a sweetly insistent chorus line. Known for his '50s ballets, Shankar teams with director Bimal Roy here to rediscover dance in its old role: as a storytelling device. Romance is in the air as you see rural life—and a certain Vyjayanthimala—through the charmed gaze of an urban outsider in Dilip Kumar.

Piya Tose Naina Laage Re

***Guide* (1965)**

Vijay Anand was one of those who had great understanding of dance picturisation on the mainstream canvas. *Piya Tose* exemplifies how he thought of dances as a key filmic artefact. A huge budget was set aside for this sprawling documentation of Rosie (Waheeda Rehman) evolving from a small dancer into a dancing star. Said to have been shot over nearly 15 days, and running some nine minutes, it showcases Hiralal's versatility as a choreographer.





Hoton Pe Aisi Baat

***Jewel Thief* (1967)**

Another Vijay Anand masterclass in storytelling through song. Choreographed by Sohanlal, Saroj Khan was an assistant on this dramatic number. It's got everything: drums, masks, suspense and a bevy of dancers whose frenetic energy is caught in all its colour through long takes. Vyjayanthimala was referred to as an *apsara* those days—her body language was reminiscent of ancient temple sculptures. An other-worldliness so key to the magic of cinema.